

combine several GIF horizontally - python

Asked 6 years, 2 months ago Modified 2 years, 7 months ago Viewed 7k times



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I have two GIF files, and I want to combine them horizontally to be shown beside each other, and they play together. They have equal frames. I tried a lot online for a solution, but didn't find something which is supporting GIF. I think the `imageio` package supports gif, but I can't find a way to use it to combine two together. Simply, I want something like this example



Any ideas of doing so ?

`python` `image` `gif` `python-imageio`

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asked Jul 25, 2018 at 11:23



Mostafa Hussein

361 4 18

stackoverflow.com/questions/30227466/... – Carlo 1585 Jul 25, 2018 at 11:42

Hello @Carlo1585 Yes exactly, I checked this and tried it. But it doesn't support GIF format, it gave me two JPG beside each other – Mostafa Hussein Jul 25, 2018 at 11:47

not sure about sorry, to be honest I never used imageio, but I'll try to investigate more. In any case I went to the imageio git project and I saw that there are still different issues with gif images so I advice you to have a look there. – Carlo 1585 Jul 25, 2018 at 11:55

No problem, thanks a lot. But apart from imageio, is there another way to do this task ?
– Mostafa Hussein Jul 25, 2018 at 11:56

Can't you use this? stackoverflow.com/a/30932152/2836621 – Mark Setchell Jul 25, 2018 at 12:04

1 Answer

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I would code something like this :

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```
import imageio
import numpy as np
```



```
#Create reader object for the gif
gif1 = imageio.get_reader('file1.gif')
gif2 = imageio.get_reader('file2.gif')
```



```
#If they don't have the same number of frame take the shorter
number_of_frames = min(gif1.get_length(), gif2.get_length())
```

```
#Create writer object
new_gif = imageio.get_writer('output.gif')
```

```
for frame_number in range(number_of_frames):
    img1 = gif1.get_next_data()
    img2 = gif2.get_next_data()
    #here is the magic
    new_image = np.hstack((img1, img2))
    new_gif.append_data(new_image)
```

```
gif1.close()
gif2.close()
new_gif.close()
```

So the magic trick is to use the `hstack` numpy function. It will basically stack them horizontally. This only work if the two gif are the same dimensions.

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edited Mar 2, 2022 at 10:10

answered Oct 29, 2019 at 15:47



Ozan Kurt

3,896 4 21 36



rponthieu dev

126 1 9

- 1 `imageio` cannot write transparency layers to GIFs, which is what bit me. Stay away if you need that! – [xjcl](#)
Jan 14, 2020 at 6:11